

Section A — Chapter 6

Mahatma Gandhi and the National Movement

Class 10 - Total History & Civics Solutions

Multiple Choice Questions

Question 1

Arrange the following historical events in the chronological order of their occurrence.

- (i) Non-Cooperation Movement
- (ii) Civil Disobedience Movement
- (iii) Chauri-Chaura Incident

- 1. (i), (ii), (iii)
- 2. (i), (iii), (ii)
- 3. (ii), (i), (iii)
- 4. (iii), (ii), (i)

Answer

(i), (iii), (ii)

Question 2

Champaran, the site of Gandhi's first experiment in Satyagraha, is located in:

- 1. Bihar
- 2. Kerala
- 3. Gujarat
- 4. Punjab

Answer

Bihar

Question 3

Complete the given analogy.

Mahatma Gandhi :?.... : : Dadabhai Naoroji : Indian Association.

1. All India Congress
2. Indian Association
3. Indian National Congress
4. Natal Indian Congress

Answer

Natal Indian Congress

Question 4

Who, among the following, presided over the historic Lahore session of 1929 of Indian National Congress?

1. Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru
2. Rajendra Prasad
3. Lala Lajpat Rai
4. Motilal Nehru

Answer

Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru

Question 5

Which of the following statements are correct?

- (i) Kheda Satyagraha was Gandhiji's experiment with Satyagraha.
- (ii) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel was the gift of the Kheda Satyagraha to the country.
- (iii) The government issued secret instructions of recovering revenue from the peasants.

1. (i) only
2. (i) and (ii) only
3. All of the above
4. None of the above.

Answer

(i) and (ii) only

Question 6

What was the key objective of Gandhiji's Champaran Movement?

1. The security of rights of harijans
2. Civil disobedience movement
3. Maintaining the unity of society
4. Solving the problem of the indigo workers

Answer

Solving the problem of the indigo workers

Question 7

In violation of the Salt Laws, Gandhiji started a movement called

1. Non-Cooperation movement
2. Swadeshi movement
3. Civil Disobedience movement
4. None of the above

Answer

Civil Disobedience movement

Question 8

In 1918, Mahatma Gandhi went to organise a Satyagraha movement for the cotton mill workers of

1. Madras
2. Bombay
3. Surat
4. Ahmedabad

Answer

Ahmedabad

Question 9

In which of the following movements did Mahatma Gandhi make the first use of Hunger Strike as a weapon?

1. Non-Cooperation Movement
2. Rowlatt Satyagraha
3. Ahmedabad Strike
4. Bardoli Satyagraha

Answer

Ahmedabad Strike

Question 10

Khilafat Movement was organised to protest against the injustice done to

1. Persia
2. Turkey
3. Arabia
4. Egypt

Answer

Turkey

Question 11

Which of the following was the achieved milestone of the Non-Cooperation Movement?

1. It stopped the injustice done to the Caliph
2. Indians obtained some political rights
3. The Hindus and the Muslims came closer in political pursuit
4. It avenged Punjab atrocities.

Answer

The Hindus and the Muslims came closer in political pursuit

Question 12

From the given list identify the recommendations of the Simon Commission.

1. Creation of 'new provinces' on the linguistic basis.
2. Dyarchy should be abolished and there should be complete autonomy in the provinces.

3. The Government should include representatives from the civil services.
4. Communal Representation should be replaced with equal representation irrespective of religion.

Answer

Dyarchy should be abolished and there should be complete autonomy in the provinces.

Question 13

Gandhiji began the Civil Disobedience Movement by breaking the Salt Laws. What did this signify?

1. Boycott of British goods
2. Defiance of British laws
3. Strikes by mill workers
4. Non-payment of British taxes.

Answer

Defiance of British laws

Question 14

The issue on which the Civil Disobedience Movement of 1930 was launched was

1. equal employment opportunities for Indians
2. the proposed execution of Bhagat Singh
3. salt monopoly exercised by the British Government
4. complete freedom.

Answer

salt monopoly exercised by the British Government

Question 15

The Civil Disobedience Movement was suspended after the Gandhi-Irwin Pact. Why did the Congress decide to resume the movement In January 1932?

1. Failure of the Second Round Table Conference
2. Repudiation of the Gandhi-Irwin Pact by the British Government
3. British policies of repression
4. All of the above

Answer

Failure of the Second Round Table Conference

Question 16

Which of the following summarises the significance of the Second Round Table Conference held at London?

- (i) It was attended by Gandhiji as the sole representative of the Congress.
- (ii) The conference was deadlocked on the issue of separate electorates.
- (iii) The British agreed to concede to the immediate grant of dominion status.

- 1. (i) and (ii)
- 2. (ii) and (iii)
- 3. (i) and (iii)
- 4. (ii) and (iii)

Answer

(i) and (ii)

Short Answer Questions

Question 1

Which period of Indian history is known as the Gandhian era and why?

Answer

Mahatma Gandhi completely dominated the Indian National Movement from 1915 to 1948. That is why, this period is known as the Gandhian era in Indian history.

Question 2

Define Satyagraha. How does it differ from Passive Resistance?

Answer

To Gandhiji, satyagraha was a moral force born of truth and non-violence. It meant to be fearless, truthful as well as peaceful, suffering willingly while refusing to submit to what is wrong. But even while resisting evil, it would not involve hatred towards the evil-doer.

Satyagraha differs from passive resistance as passive resistance does not exclude the use of physical force for the purpose of gaining one's end, whereas Satyagraha excludes the use of violence.

Question 3

How did Gandhiji involve Indian masses in the National Movement?

Answer

Gandhiji involved Indian masses in the national movement by unifying the people of the country. He took up the causes of the common people of the country. For example, he took up the issues faced by the indigo farmers in Champaran, then he fought for the demands of mill workers in Ahmedabad and also tried to resolve the issues faced by the farmers of Kheda.

People began to believe so much into him that he came to be known as the Mahatma. He was able to move people with his speeches. He started the Civil Disobedience Movement by breaking salt laws. He chose salt because it was used by each section of the society. It was because of his charismatic leadership that he was able to draw masses into the national movement.

Question 4

Why did Gandhiji launch satyagraha at Ahmedabad in 1918? What was the outcome of Gandhiji's satyagraha at Ahmedabad?

Answer

Gandhiji led the mill-workers of Ahmedabad in a strike against the mill-owners who had refused to pay them higher wages. When the workers seemed to weaken, he provided support to them by undertaking a fast (hunger strike). Afraid of the consequences, the mill-owners agreed on the fourth day of Gandhiji's fast to give a 35 per cent increase in wages.

Question 5

What was the Rowlatt Act of 1919? What was Gandhiji's reaction to the Rowlatt Act of 1919?

Answer

The Rowlatt Act authorised the Government to imprison any person without trial and convict him in a court. It implied:

1. Arrest of a person without warrant.
2. In camera trial (trial in seclusion).
3. Restrictions on movements of individuals.
4. Suspension of the Right of Habeas Corpus.

Gandhiji appealed to the Viceroy to withhold his consent to the Rowlatt Act. However his appeal was ignored. He started 'Satyagraha' as a challenge to the government.

Question 6

Name the leaders of the Khilafat Movement launched in India to champion the cause of the Caliph of Turkey. How did the Khilafat Movement come to an end?

Answer

The leaders of the Khilafat Movement launched in India to champion the cause of the Caliph of Turkey were-

1. Mohammad Ali
2. Shaukat Ali

The Khilafat Movement died a natural death when in November 1922 Mustafa Kemal Pasha deposed the Sultan of Turkey and showed no concern for the holy places of Islam. He finally abolished the Caliphate and separated the State from religion. Mustafa modernised education, agriculture and industry. He developed Turkey on secular and progressive lines.

Question 7

Name three events which disillusioned Gandhiji and turned him into a non-cooperator from a cooperator with the British government.

Answer

The three events which disillusioned Gandhiji and turned him into a non-cooperator from a cooperator with the British government were-

1. Passing of the Rowlatt Act, 1919
2. The Jallianwala Bagh tragedy
3. The Khilafat wrongs

Question 8

What were the steps taken by the people as a part of the Khilafat Non-Cooperation Movement?

Answer

The steps taken by the people as a part of the Khilafat Non-Cooperation Movement were as follows-

1. People resigned from government services
2. Shops selling foreign goods were picketed

3. Students boycotted schools and colleges
4. 'Hartals' and demonstrations were held.

In 1921, the Khilafat Committee appealed to all the Muslims not to join the police and armed forces and not to pay taxes.

Question 9

Name the three components of the constructive programme adopted by Gandhiji after the suspension of the Non-Cooperation Movement.

Answer

The three components of the constructive programme adopted by Gandhiji after the suspension of the Non-Cooperation Movement were-

1. Removal of untouchability
2. Hindu-Muslim unity
3. The popularisation of Swadeshi and Khadi

Question 10

Why was the Simon Commission boycotted everywhere in India? Name the national leader who succumbed to the lathi charge during the protest movement against the Simon Commission.

Answer

The Simon Commission was boycotted everywhere in India because the Commission was composed of seven British members of Parliament. It had no Indian member. This was seen as a violation of the principle of self-determination and a deliberate insult to the self-respect of the Indians.

Lala Lajpat Rai succumbed to the lathi charge during the protest movement against the Simon Commission.

Question 11

Why is the Congress Session held at Lahore in 1929 significant in India's Freedom Movement?

Answer

The Congress Session held at Lahore in 1929 is significant in India's Freedom Movement because the Congress passed a resolution declaring Poorna Swaraj (complete independence) to be its objective for the first time.

Question 12

What did the programme of Civil Disobedience Movement consist of?

Answer

The programme of Civil Disobedience Movement involved

1. Defiance of Salt Laws
2. Boycott of liquor
3. Boycott of foreign cloth and British goods of all kinds
4. Non-payment of taxes and revenues

Question 13

Why did Mahatma Gandhi start his historic march to Dandi?

Answer

Mahatma Gandhi started his historic march to Dandi to attack the Salt Law according to which the government had the monopoly to manufacture and sell salt.

Question 14

Who took the leadership of the Civil Disobedience Movement in the extreme north-western part of the country? What was he popularly known as and what was the name of the organisation formed by him?

Answer

Abdul Ghaffar Khan took the leadership of the Civil Disobedience Movement in the extreme north-western part of the country.

He was popularly known as Frontier Gandhi.

The name of the organisation formed by him was Khudai Khidmatgars.

Question 15

Mention any two terms (provisions) of the Gandhi-Irwin Pact.

Answer

According to the terms (provisions) of the Gandhi-Irwin Pact, the government agreed to:

1. Withdraw all ordinances and end prosecutions.
2. Release all political prisoners, except those guilty of violence.

Question 16

Which law was defied by Gandhiji's Dandi March? Why was this law selected to be defied?

Answer

Salt law was defied by Gandhiji's Dandi March.

This law was selected to be defied because the salt tax affected all sections of the society, especially the poor.

Structured Questions

Question 1

Gandhiji introduced new ideas in politics and adopted new methods to give a new direction to the political movement. In this context, answer the following questions:

- (a) What was Gandhiji's doctrine of Satyagraha?
- (b) Explain briefly Gandhiji's Social Ideals.
- (c) Which mass struggle was launched by him on non-violent lines in 1920? Explain in brief the programmes of such a campaign.

Answer

(a) Gandhiji's doctrine of Satyagraha was an effective method of the National Movement.

1. The term Satyagraha is made up of two Sanskrit words—Satya (truth) and Agraha (insistence to hold fast).
2. To Gandhiji, satyagraha was a moral force born of truth and non-violence.
3. It meant to be fearless, truthful as well as peaceful, suffering willingly while refusing to submit to what is wrong.
4. But even while resisting evil, it would not involve hatred towards the evil-doer.
5. Gandhiji's Satyagraha Movement was directed against the British system of exploitation and not the British people individually or collectively.
6. Gandhiji made a distinction between Satyagraha and passive resistance.
7. Passive resistance does not exclude the use of physical force for the purpose of gaining one's end, whereas Satyagraha excludes the use of violence.

(b) Gandhiji's Social Ideals:

Gandhiji's whole philosophy was based on non-violence.

1. According to Gandhiji, it is the weapon of strong, mighty and powerful individuals.

2. He was of the opinion that neither an individual nor a country could gain anything by using violent methods.
3. He launched many movements for gaining freedom but none of them was violent.
4. During the non-cooperation movement, he suspended the movement when it was at its zenith just because of Chauri Chaura incident in which 22 British policemen were burnt alive.

(c) Gandhiji launched the Non-Cooperation Movement on non-violent lines in 1920. The movement included the following programmes:

Boycott programmes

1. Boycott of government schools, colleges and courts.
2. Boycott of foreign goods.
3. Boycott of elections to be held for the Councils as suggested by the reforms of 1919.
4. Resignation from nominated seats in local bodies.
5. Surrender of titles and honorary offices.
6. Refusal to attend government functions.

Swadeshi programmes

1. Popularisation of Swadeshi and Khadi by reviving hand-spinning and hand-weaving.
2. Establishment of national schools and colleges and private arbitration courts known as panchayats all over India.
3. Development of unity between Hindus and Muslims.
4. Removal of untouchability and other measures for Harijan welfare.
5. Emancipation and upliftment of women.

Question 2

The Simon Commission was appointed in November 1927 by the British Government. Subsequently the Civil Disobedience Movement began. In this context answer the following questions:

- (a) Why was the Simon Commission appointed by the British Government? Why did the Congress boycott the Commission?
- (b) The Civil Disobedience Movement was launched by Gandhiji with his famous Dandi March. Mention the significance of this historic event.
- (c) Why did Gandhiji suspend Civil Disobedience Movement in 1931 and later in 1934 call it off?

Answer

(a) In November 1927, the British Government appointed the Indian Statutory Commission, popularly known as the Simon Commission, to investigate the need for further constitutional reforms. The Commission was composed of seven British members of Parliament.

The commission had no Indian member. This was seen as a violation of the principle of self-determination and a deliberate insult to the self-respect of the Indians. Hence, at its Madras session in 1927, presided over by Dr. Ansari, the National Congress decided to boycott the commission 'at every stage and in every form'.

(b) Gandhiji started the Civil Disobedience Movement with his famous Dandi March.

1. On 12th March, Mahatma Gandhi began the historic march from Sabarmati Ashram to Dandi, a village on the Gujarat sea coast.
2. A number of people followed him.
3. On the morning of 6th April, Gandhiji violated the Salt Law at Dandi by picking up some salt left by the sea waves.
4. According to the Salt Law, the government had the monopoly to manufacture and sell salt.
5. He had selected to attack the Salt Laws because the salt-tax affected all sections of society, especially the poor.
6. Gandhiji's breaking of the Salt Laws marked the beginning of the Civil Disobedience Movement.

(c) Since the satyagraha could not be suppressed, the Government, through Tej Bahadur Sapru and Jayakar, started negotiations with Gandhiji in jail.

1. This resulted in the signing of a pact by Gandhiji and Lord Irwin, the Viceroy, in March 1931.
2. This is known as the Gandhi-Irwin Pact.
3. According to the terms of the pact, the Congress consented to suspend the Civil Disobedience Movement in 1931.
4. The Great Depression of 1930s in the world had hit the farmers in India.
5. Gandhiji sought an interview with Viceroy Willingdon. The interview was refused.
6. The Congress passed a resolution for the renewal of the Civil Disobedience Movement.
7. Government resorted to repression, issued Ordinances and assumed special powers.
8. The Congress was declared illegal.
9. Congress leaders were arrested and their properties were seized. Communalism was fanned.
10. Gradually the Civil Disobedience Movement lost its force and Congress called it off in 1934.

Picture Study

Question 1

Study the picture given here and answer the following questions:



- (a) What was symbolised by the Charkha and Khadi in the National Movement?
- (b) What is meant by Swadeshi? Why did Gandhiji lay emphasis on Swadeshi?
- (c) State how was the concept of Swadeshi promoted during the Non-Cooperation Movement?

Answer

(a) Mahatma Gandhi saw the Charkha as a symbol of a human society that would not glorify machines and technology.

1. The spinning wheel, moreover, could provide the poor with supplementary income and make them self-reliant.
2. Khadi does not seek to destroy all machinery but it does regulate its use and check its weedy growth.
3. It uses machinery for the service of the poorest in their own cottages.

4. The wheel is itself an exquisite piece of machinery.

(b) Swadeshi means producing necessary items in one's own country and using them for one's use without being dependent on imported goods. Gandhiji believed that the use of Swadeshi goods would make us self-sufficient and eliminate our dependence on imported goods. Gandhiji emphasised manual labour and the use of the Charkha and Khadi. He popularised Swadeshi and Khadi by reviving hand spinning and hand weaving.

(c) The Non-Cooperation Movement involved Swadeshi programmes which included-

1. Popularisation of Swadeshi and Khadi by reviving hand-spinning and hand-weaving.
2. Establishment of national schools and colleges and private arbitration courts known as panchayats all over India.
3. Development of unity between Hindus and Muslims.
4. Removal of untouchability and other measures for Harijan welfare.
5. Emancipation and upliftment of women.

Question 2

In 1930 Mahatma Gandhi's demands were rejected by the British, as a result of which he launched the Civil Disobedience Movement. In this context, explain the following:



(a) Name the famous march undertaken by Gandhiji. Where did he begin this march? State two of its features.

(b) How was this Movement different from the Non-Cooperation Movement?

(c) Explain briefly how did Mahatma Gandhi try to promote Hindu-Muslim unity from the Rowlatt Satyagraha to the Third Round Table conference.

Answer

(a) The famous march undertaken by Gandhiji was the Dandi March.

1. On 12th March, Mahatma Gandhi began the historic march from Sabarmati Ashram to Dandi, a village on the Gujarat sea coast.
2. A number of people followed him.
3. On the morning of 6th April, Gandhiji violated the Salt Law at Dandi by picking up some salt left by the sea waves.
4. According to the Salt Law, the government had the monopoly to manufacture and sell salt.
5. He had selected to attack the Salt Laws because the salt-tax affected all sections of society, especially the poor.
6. Gandhiji's breaking of the Salt Laws marked the beginning of the Civil Disobedience Movement.

(b) Civil Disobedience Movement was different from the Non-Cooperation Movement as the former involved non-payment of taxes and land revenue as well as violation of laws of different kinds in addition to non-cooperation activities.

(c) Mahatma Gandhi tried to promote Hindu-Muslim unity from the Rowlatt Satyagraha to the Third Round Table conference in the following ways-

1. **Rowlatt Satyagraha** — An important feature of the Rowlatt Satyagraha was Hindu-Muslim unity. This was the call given by Mahatma Gandhi, who always saw a unified India belonging to the people of all religions. He wanted that Hindus and Muslims should support each other in any just cause.
2. **Khilafat movement** — Gandhiji saw in the Khilafat Movement an opportunity for uniting Hindus and Muslims. He said that the Congress plea for Hindu-Muslim unity "would be an empty phrase if the Hindus hold aloof from the Muslims when their vital interests are at stake".
3. **Non-Cooperation Movement** — It fostered Hindu-Muslim unity which could be seen in the merger of the Khilafat issue with this Movement. It provided an opportunity to the Congress to bring the urban Muslims into the National Movement by convincing them that the nation was equally concerned with the problems affecting them.

Thinking Skills

Question 1

Suppose you recently visited Jallianwala Bagh Memorial in Amritsar. While you were there, you could visualise what might have happened on that unfortunate day on April 13, 1919. Describe the scene of the tragedy as visualised by you.

Answer

On April 13, 1919, a large crowd had gathered at Jallianwala Bagh in Amritsar to celebrate Baisakhi and peacefully protest against the arrest of leaders like Dr. Saifuddin Kitchlu and Dr. Satya Pal. Speeches were in progress and people were sloganeering and there was peace and order all around. Suddenly General Dyer along with his soldiers marched in and surrounded the Bagh. After closing the only exit of the garden, he ordered the soldiers to start shooting. There was chaos and confusion all around. People started running frantically to save their lives, unsuccessfully trying to escape by climbing the walls. The atmosphere was filled with helpless cries of people and the firing of bullets. Many people jumped inside the well in the garden to escape the bullets. The troops kept on firing till their ammunition was exhausted. After the troops withdrew, there was death and despair all around. There were bodies everywhere and people's belongings, clothes, shoes and pagris (turbans) were scattered all over the ground. At some places, 7 or 8 corpses were piled, one over another. There were many innocent children among the dead too, some as young as 3 years old. The atrocities of General Dyer transformed Jallianwala Bagh from the site of peaceful protest to the garden of the dead.

Question 2

Do you think that the Civil Disobedience Movement in 1930 marked the entry of women on the Indian political scene? Did it have any effect on the position of women?

Answer

The Civil Disobedience Movement brought women out of their homes to participate in politics and to make them equal partners in freedom struggle. During Gandhiji's salt march, thousands of women came out of their homes to listen to him. They participated in protest marches, manufactured salt, and picketed foreign cloth and liquor shops. Many went to jail. Moved by Gandhiji's call, they began to see service to the nation as a sacred duty of women. However, this did not result in any change in their social position. For a long time the Congress was reluctant to allow women to hold any position of authority within the organization. It was keen only on their symbolic presence.

Question 3

How did the Civil Disobedience Movement create a sense of collective belonging that resulted in the spread of nationalism?

Answer

The Civil Disobedience Movement created a sense of collective belonging resulting in the spread of nationalism in the following ways:

1. The Movement caused a tide of patriotic fervour in the country that would not leave the Government in peace.
2. The Civil Disobedience Movement widened the base of the freedom struggle. A large number of social groups like merchants and shopkeepers, peasants, tribals and workers in different parts of the country were mobilised for the Indian national movement.
3. It made people understand the significance of the principles of non-violence. People could resist violence with tolerance and courage.
4. The Movement under the leadership of Birla and the 'Harijan Sevak Sangh' changed the social conditions. The depressed classes were given entry into temples and access to wells, which was earlier denied to them.
5. It brought women out of their homes to participate in politics and to make them equal partners in the freedom struggle.
6. The movement revived the will to fight the elections.